

Response Splitting Filter Evasion ha.ckers.org web application security lab

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Content

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Response Splitting Filter Evasion

While playing with a redirection issue on a pretty major website I found a pretty weird [HTTP response splitting](#) issue, where forward slashes were not allowed (or rather, once you entered a forward slash it caused the whole redirection to be removed). Clearly the website was trying to protect itself from something, although I'm not exactly sure how or why. Here's what I ended up doing.

Normally it would just do something like Location: <http://somesite.com/> where whatever you typed in the URL field would end up in the Location header. Pretty typical response splitting I'd think, except I can't inject a slash, so ending HTML tags are out (shouldn't be a problem) but now I can't get it from plaintext format into HTML making any HTML injection pointless.

So I ended up shortening the response splitting by instead of typing in Content-Type: text/html I just put in Content-Type: html (I removed "text/" which isn't important to the attack. So it ended up looking like:

```
%0AContent-Type:html%0A%0A%3Cbody%20onload=alert(%22XSS%22)%3E
```

I can't help but think there are nearly as many variants of response splitting as there are traditional [XSS](#) attacks. Just another reason not to have open redirection on your site.

This entry was posted on Sunday, August 27th, 2006 at 7:38 pm and is filed under [XSS](#), [Webappsec](#). You can [\[leave a response\]](#)() as well.

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